

Q Why did Facebook opt for open source?

Open source is an important part of our engineering culture, and this has been the case ever since the site was first built on platforms like Apache, PHP and MySQL back in 2004. Since then, we have learned to share our work as responsible stewards of projects like HHVM, React, React Native and hundreds of others.

We see lots of advantages in bringing the community and industry together to openly share ideas about how to solve new engineering problems caused by scale, how to innovate faster, and how to share insights into the sort of technical challenges that Facebook needs to address.

Q In what ways is the Open Compute Project crucial for developing regions like India?

The Open Compute Project (OCP) has allowed us to take the same kind of creativity and collaboration we see in open source software to the hardware space. Through the OCP community, we have been able to break open the traditional black box of proprietary infrastructure, and foster a collaborative and open community around the world. The project provides a structure for individuals and organisations to share designs with others and help the data centre and hardware industries evolve.

By openly sharing ideas and specifications, we can reduce complexities in tech components that limit our ability to innovate more quickly. This approach is beneficial to everyone because we can leverage more choices to achieve better flexibility in how we build hardware and software in the data centre.

Q How did you build a community to handle open source developments?

There is no one-size-fits-all. Every open source project at Facebook is a little different, and the way we work with various communities varies (both technically and geographically). Some have active meet-up events, while some have regular blog posts. Others focus solely on a specific project to work through issues and pull requests that have come in.

My team is here to make sure that the people on each project think about this and do the job well — and that the best techniques for community engagement are shared. There are definitely several things that are common across all our active projects.

First, we make sure that our open source projects are well aligned with the work that we do. So, for example, the commits our engineers make are being shared to GitHub in real-time, and the community can follow along as our work happens. This also means that incoming contributions are accepted quickly without merge issues.

Second, we work hard to support the early adopters of our projects, giving them advice, pointers to possible areas of contribution, and lots of recognition. This first wave of community membership then goes on to help us advocate the next people that want to be involved.

And finally, we always try to celebrate the work that community members or other companies do, whether large or

small. Sometimes the most important thing about a community is to know about all the other things that are happening in it!

Q Where does India stand in terms of open source contributors?

India is an important country for Facebook, and the largest country for developers building with Facebook outside of the US. With more than 70 per cent of Facebook's developer ecosystem based outside of the US, our developer community is bigger and more global than ever.

With 1.7 billion people on Facebook and more coming online every day, we want to help developers around the world build engaging, useful experiences and services that make people's lives better. One of the ways we help developers grow is with free tools and services to either get their businesses up and running or take these to the next stage of growth with our FbStart program. Through openness and collaboration around the world, developers can quickly build businesses that are global and scalable.

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Q Do you consider Indian developers as capable of building interesting open source solutions as the developers in the US and other developed markets?

Absolutely! One of the many benefits of open source is that anyone in the world can have access to and share ideas and resources, so that we can solve more complex technical challenges than we would on our own.

It is fascinating to see how companies of all sizes and in various industries can quickly discover more creative ways to address new engineering challenges through openness and collaboration. As more people come online, the open source community is growing to more regions across the globe, which means there is an opportunity to make the world more open and connected through two-way dialogues in code. On an open source project, sometimes you never even know where in the world your community and collaborators are actually living!

Q Any particular inspiration behind Facebook's open source adoption?

Open source is a catalyst for faster development. But, at the same time, it is also the right thing to do. At Facebook, our mission is to make the world more open and connected, and we believe this approach applies to the craft of developing software just as much as it does to connecting people on Facebook itself.

By making our projects open, developers can share ideas across companies and work on the code together, thus speeding